Analog Devices (*www.analog.com/dsp*)
ADSP-21xx 16 bit, fixed point
ADSP-21xxx 32 bit, floating and fixed point

Lucent Technologies (*www.lucent.com*)
DSP16xxx 16 bit fixed point
DSP32xx 32 bit floating point

Motorola (*www.mot.com*)
DSP561xx 16 bit fixed point
DSP560xx 24 bit, fixed point
DSP96002 32 bit, floating point

Texas Instruments (*www.ti.com*)
TMS320Cxx 16 bit fixed point
TMS320Cxx 32 bit floating point

Keep in mind that the distinction between DSPs and other microprocessors is not always a clear line. For instance, look at how Intel describes the MMX technology addition to its Pentium processor:

> *"Intel engineers have added 57 powerful new instructions specifically designed to manipulate and process video, audio and graphical data efficiently. These instructions are oriented to the highly parallel, repetitive sequences often found in multimedia operations."*

In the future, we will undoubtedly see more DSP-like functions merged into traditional microprocessors and microcontrollers. The internet and other multimedia applications are a strong driving force for these changes. These applications are expanding so rapidly, in twenty years it is very possible that the Digital Signal Processor may *be* the "traditional" microprocessor.

How do you keep up with this rapidly changing field? The best way is to read trade journals that cover the DSP market, such as EDN (Electronic Design News, *www.ednmag.com*), and ECN (Electronic Component News, *www.ecnmag.com*). These are distributed free, and contain up-to-date information on what is available and where the industry is going. Trade journals are a "must-read" for anyone serious about the field. You will also want to be on the mailing list of several DSP manufacturers. This will allow you to receive new product announcements, pricing information, and special offers (such as free software and low-cost evaluation kits). Some manufacturers also distribute periodic newsletters. For instance, Analog Devices publishes *Analog Dialogue* four times a year, containing articles